

STRUCTURED LEARNING PATH • 2026

60-Day Cybersecurity Roadmap

6 Structured Phases • 60 Daily Topics • 60 Free Video References • Measurable Learning Outcomes

PHASE 1 Security Fundamentals Days 1-10	PHASE 2 Linux & System Security Days 11-20	PHASE 3 Web App Security Days 21-30
PHASE 4 Network & Pentesting Days 31-40	PHASE 5 Cloud Security Days 41-50	PHASE 6 Advanced & Specialized Days 51-60

60 DAYS	6 PHASES	60 VIDEOS	15+ CHANNELS
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DAY	PHASE	TOPIC / SKILL	LEARNING OUTCOME	VIDEO REFERENCE
Phase 1: Security Fundamentals Days 1-10				
1	P1	CIA Triad & Core Security Concepts	Define CIA triad; differentiate threats vs vulnerabilities vs risks; understand attack surfaces and exposure	Professor Messer CompTIA Security+ SY0-701 Full Course
2	P1	OSI Model & TCP/IP Stack	Map all 7 OSI layers to real protocols; trace packet flow end-to-end; identify layer-specific attack vectors	NetworkChuck OSI Model Explained Real World Examples
3	P1	Core Network Protocols (DNS, HTTP, FTP, SMTP)	Explain DNS resolution lifecycle; contrast HTTP vs HTTPS; identify common protocol-level vulnerabilities	David Bombal How DNS Works - Network Fundamentals
4	P1	Firewalls, IDS & IPS	Distinguish stateful vs stateless filtering; write basic ACL rules; compare signature vs anomaly-based detection	Professor Messer Firewalls, IDS and IPS - CompTIA Security+
5	P1	Cryptography Fundamentals	Contrast symmetric vs asymmetric encryption; explain SHA-256/MD5 hashing; identify encryption use cases	Computerphile Cryptography: Crash Course Computer Science
6	P1	PKI & Digital Certificates	Trace chain of trust from Root CA to end-entity cert; analyze TLS handshake; identify certificate misconfiguration risks	Professor Messer PKI Components - CompTIA Security+ SY0-701
7	P1	Authentication, Authorization & MFA	Implement MFA concepts; differentiate OAuth 2.0, SAML, LDAP; identify authentication bypass techniques	Simply Cyber IAM Fundamentals - Identity & Access Management
8	P1	Vulnerability Management Lifecycle	Execute credentialed scan; prioritize CVEs using CVSS v3; map findings to risk-tiered remediation roadmap	TCM Security Vulnerability Scanning with Nessus - Tutorial
9	P1	Threat Intelligence & MITRE ATT&CK;	Identify IOCs and IOAs; map adversary TTPs to ATT&CK; techniques; perform basic STRIDE threat modeling	Simply Cyber Threat Intelligence Fundamentals for Defenders
10	P1	Security Frameworks (NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS)	Apply NIST CSF's 5 functions; close gaps with CIS Controls v8; understand ISO 27001 ISMS scope	Simply Cyber NIST Cybersecurity Framework Explained
Phase 2: Linux & System Security Days 11-20				
11	P2	Linux CLI Fundamentals for Security	Navigate filesystem; manage processes; use grep/awk for log analysis; write bash scripts for security tasks	NetworkChuck Linux for Hackers // FREE Course (ep 1-5)
12	P2	Linux Users, Permissions & SUID/SGID	Configure sudoers securely; audit SUID binaries with find; understand sticky bits and security implications	HackerSploit Linux Privilege Escalation - File Permissions
13	P2	Linux Networking & iptables Hardening	Write iptables chain rules; harden SSH config (key auth, port); enumerate connections with ss and netstat	HackerSploit Linux Firewall Tutorial - iptables Full Guide
14	P2	Windows Security Fundamentals	Configure Defender and host firewall; read Event Viewer logs (4624/4625/4648); harden registry and UAC	David Bombal Windows Security - Ethical Hacking Course
15	P2	Active Directory Security & Attack Vectors	Map AD objects and GPO hierarchy; understand Kerberoasting and Pass-the-Hash; enumerate with BloodHound CE	TCM Security Practical Active Directory - Full Free Course
16	P2	Linux Privilege Escalation	Find and exploit SUID binaries; abuse misconfigured cron jobs and writable PATH entries; leverage GTFOBins	TCM Security Linux Privilege Escalation for Beginners

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17	P2	Windows Privilege Escalation	Exploit unquoted service paths; perform token impersonation; use WinPEAS and PowerUp for enumeration	TCM Security Windows Privilege Escalation for Beginners
18	P2	Log Analysis & SIEM Architecture	Parse Windows and Linux logs; correlate multi-source events; understand SIEM normalization and enrichment pipelines	John Hammond Log Analysis for Blue Teamers - Beginner Guide
19	P2	Wazuh SIEM Deployment & Configuration	Deploy Wazuh all-in-one on Ubuntu; onboard agents; write XML detection rules; configure alert channels	HackerSploit Wazuh SIEM - Complete Setup & Configuration
20	P2	Incident Response (IR) Lifecycle	Execute 6-phase NIST IR process; perform containment and eradication; write structured after-action IR report	Simply Cyber Incident Response Explained - SOC Operations
Phase 3: Web App Security Days 21-30				
21	P3	HTTP/HTTPS, Cookies & Web Architecture	Analyze HTTP request/response headers; understand cookie flags (SameSite/HttpOnly/Secure); map web architecture	NetworkChuck HTTP Crash Course & Exploration
22	P3	OWASP Top 10 (2021) Overview	Identify all 10 vulnerability categories; map each to real exploits; prioritize testing order by impact	TCM Security OWASP Top 10 - Web Application Security
23	P3	SQL Injection (SQLi)	Identify SQLi entry points; automate with sqlmap; implement prepared statements and parameterized queries	PortSwigger SQL Injection - Web Security Academy Labs
24	P3	Cross-Site Scripting (XSS)	Execute reflected, stored, DOM-based XSS; bypass basic filters; implement output encoding and CSP defenses	LiveOverflow XSS - Cross-Site Scripting Explained
25	P3	CSRF, SSRF & Security Misconfigurations	Exploit CSRF via crafted requests; demonstrate SSRF against metadata endpoints; remediate common misconfigs	STOK SSRF Explained - Server-Side Request Forgery
26	P3	Broken Authentication & JWT Attacks	Test JWT for algorithm confusion and weak secrets; exploit session fixation; identify OAuth 2.0 flaws	PortSwigger JWT Attacks - Web Security Academy Labs
27	P3	API Security & OWASP API Top 10	Enumerate REST and GraphQL APIs; identify BOLA and BFLA; implement rate limiting and API authentication	STOK API Hacking - Broken Object Level Authorization
28	P3	Burp Suite Professional - Deep Dive	Use Intruder for fuzzing; configure active scanner; chain Repeater requests for multi-step exploit chains	TCM Security Burp Suite Masterclass - Full Tutorial
29	P3	Web App Penetration Testing Methodology	Apply OWASP WSTG structured methodology; use Nikto and OWASP ZAP; document findings professionally	TCM Security Practical Web Application Hacking - Full Course
30	P3	Security Headers & Content Security Policy	Implement HSTS, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options; write and validate CSP directives; write developer tickets	John Hammond Security Headers - CSP and HTTP Security
Phase 4: Network & Pentesting Days 31-40				
31	P4	Reconnaissance & OSINT Methodology	Passive recon with theHarvester, Shodan, Maltego; subdomain enumeration with amass; build target intel profile	TCM Security OSINT Fundamentals - Practical Ethical Hacking
32	P4	Nmap & Advanced Network Scanning	Execute host discovery, service detection, OS fingerprinting; interpret NSE scripts; apply IDS evasion techniques	NetworkChuck Nmap - The Absolute Beginner's Guide

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33	P4	Vulnerability Scanning (Nessus / OpenVAS)	Configure credentialed scans; interpret CVSS v3 scores; generate prioritized business-risk remediation reports	David Bombal Nessus Vulnerability Scanner - Full Tutorial
34	P4	Metasploit Framework	Search, configure, execute exploits; interact with Meterpreter for post-exploitation; pivot through networks	HackerSploit Metasploit Framework - Complete Tutorial
35	P4	Password Attacks & Credential Cracking	Crack NTLM/bcrypt with Hashcat and John; execute rule-based attacks; defend with salting and MFA enforcement	TCM Security Password Cracking - Practical Ethical Hacking
36	P4	Wireless Network Security	Capture WPA2 4-way handshake; crack PSK with aircrack-ng; implement WPA3-Enterprise and 802.1X	David Bombal WiFi Hacking - WPA2 Cracking with Aircrack-ng
37	P4	Social Engineering & Phishing Simulation	Analyze spear-phishing attack vectors; design user awareness training; deploy GoPhish for controlled campaigns	TCM Security Social Engineering - Practical Ethical Hacking
38	P4	Post-Exploitation & Lateral Movement	Enumerate post-exploitation artifacts; execute Pass-the-Hash and PtT attacks; establish persistence	John Hammond Post-Exploitation Techniques - Red Team Labs
39	P4	Penetration Test Report Writing	Write executive summary with business impact; document findings with CVSS and PoC; structure remediation steps	TCM Security Writing a Professional Penetration Testing Report
40	P4	CTF Practice & Methodology Consolidation	Complete 3+ TryHackMe/HackTheBox beginner machines; apply full pentest chain; identify remaining knowledge gaps	IppSec HackTheBox - Beginner Machine Walkthrough Series
Phase 5: Cloud Security Days 41-50				
41	P5	Cloud Security Fundamentals & Shared Responsibility	Map IaaS/PaaS/SaaS boundaries; identify cloud threats (misconfiguration, IAM abuse); apply CSA CCM	Simply Cyber Cloud Security Fundamentals Explained
42	P5	Microsoft Defender for Cloud & Secure Score	Navigate Defender for Cloud; improve Secure Score; configure HIPAA and SOC 2 regulatory compliance standards	John Savill Microsoft Defender for Cloud - Complete Deep Dive
43	P5	Azure AD / Entra ID & Conditional Access	Configure Conditional Access; implement PIM for JIT privileged roles; review Identity Protection risk signals	John Savill Azure AD & Identity - Entra ID Deep Dive
44	P5	Azure Network Security (NSG, WAF, Firewall)	Configure NSG flow logs; deploy App Gateway WAF with OWASP 3.2 ruleset; implement Azure DDoS Standard Protection	John Savill Azure Network Security - NSG, Firewall & WAF
45	P5	Microsoft Sentinel - SOC Operations	Deploy Sentinel workspace; connect M365 Defender connectors; write KQL analytics rules; investigate incidents	John Hammond Microsoft Sentinel - Full SOC Setup Guide
46	P5	Azure Governance, RBAC & Compliance	Assign least-privilege RBAC roles; implement Azure Policy deny effects; generate HIPAA compliance report	John Savill Azure Governance - Policy, RBAC and Compliance
47	P5	AWS Security (IAM, GuardDuty, CloudTrail, S3)	Write least-privilege IAM policies; enable GuardDuty; audit S3 bucket ACLs and block public access settings	NetworkChuck AWS Security Fundamentals - IAM & GuardDuty
48	P5	Cloud Penetration Testing Methodology	Use Prowler and ScoutSuite for assessments; identify IAM priv esc paths; enumerate exposed storage endpoints	TCM Security Cloud Penetration Testing - Azure & AWS
49	P5	Container Security (Docker & Kubernetes)	Scan images with Trivy; harden Docker daemon config; implement K8s RBAC, NetworkPolicy, Pod Security Standards	NetworkChuck Docker Security - Container Hardening Best Practices

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50	P5	DevSecOps & Secure CI/CD Pipelines	Integrate SAST/DAST into GitHub Actions; implement secret scanning with gitleaks; use Checkov for IaC security	David Bombal DevSecOps - Securing Your CI/CD Pipeline
Phase 6: Advanced & Specialized Days 51-60				
51	P6	Threat Hunting Fundamentals	Build ATT&CK-based; hunt hypotheses; query SIEM with KQL/SPL for behavioral IOCs; produce reusable hunt playbooks	Black Hills InfoSec Introduction to Threat Hunting - SOC Operations
52	P6	Digital Forensics & Evidence Handling	Acquire disk images with dd/FTK Imager; analyze memory with Volatility 3; maintain chain of custody docs	13Cubed Digital Forensics for Beginners - Full Tutorial
53	P6	Malware Analysis Introduction	Set up isolated sandbox; perform static analysis with PESTudio; run dynamic analysis on any.run; extract IOCs	John Hammond Malware Analysis for Beginners - Full Guide
54	P6	Advanced Wazuh - Custom Rules & Detection	Write XML detection rules with custom decoders; build Kibana SOC dashboards; tune alert thresholds to reduce FP rate	HackerSploit Wazuh Advanced - Custom Rules & Dashboard Config
55	P6	Healthcare IT Security & HIPAA Compliance	Map HIPAA Security Rule safeguards to Azure/M365 controls; identify PHI exposure scenarios; draft risk assessment	Simply Cyber HIPAA Security Rule for IT Professionals
56	P6	LLM Security - OWASP LLM Top 10	Execute prompt injection and jailbreak exploits; identify data poisoning risks; apply OWASP LLM Top 10 mitigations	David Bombal AI Security - Hacking LLMs & Prompt Injection
57	P6	Zero Trust Architecture (NIST SP 800-207)	Design identity-centric micro-segmentation; configure Never-Trust-Always-Verify policies; validate ZTA vs NIST 800-207	John Savill Zero Trust Architecture Deep Dive - NIST 800-207
58	P6	Red Team vs Blue Team - Purple Team Ops	Simulate ATT&CK; TTPs; align red team findings with detection gaps; produce purple team engagement report	Black Hills InfoSec Purple Team Operations - Red vs Blue
59	P6	Certifications Roadmap & Career Planning	Map certs (CompTIA, OSCP, CISSP, AZ-500, CLLMSE) to career track; build 12-month study plan; close skill gaps	Simply Cyber Cybersecurity Certifications Roadmap 2026
60	P6	Capstone - Full Review & Portfolio Building	Complete 5 intermediate CTF challenges; document all 60-day competencies; publish findings to personal GitHub portfolio	IppSec HackTheBox - Intermediate Machine Walkthrough Series